

BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter 
in association with

Welcome to Issue 22 of the Bernera News.

We've been learning Gaelic of late, and are currently learning about the weather. It's perfect timing, as most conversations at the moment seem to be about the weather, in particular how windy or wet it's been. We particularly like the phrase "Side nan seachd siann", which roughly translates as "the weather of the seven elements". We certainly seem to have had a bit of that of late, although maybe lacking in the sun!

The storm that hit most recently seems to have wreaked a little more havoc than usual, possibly because of the unusual angle it hit from. However, the one positive of such a time has been seeing people within the community coming together to help and ensure that everyone was safe.

From phone calls on the night, to the clearing up of debris. Bernera has always excelled at looking after each other, and long may it continue. Help will always be available for those who need it, don't ever be afraid to ask.

Contact us at: 01851 600 159

Text/Whatsapp: 07958 549784

Email: hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk

Or visit us online at:

www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk

COVID UPDATE

Many of the restrictions that were imposed to help reduce the spread of the newer Omicron variant of Covid-19 have now been lifted. From Monday 24th January there are no longer limits on attendance at indoor public events; different groups in indoor public places are no longer required to maintain 1 metre physical distancing; and table service in alcohol serving hospitality services is no longer necessary.

The guidance asking people to stick to a 3 household limit on indoor gatherings has also been lifted.

However, the Covid certification scheme will continue to apply for now to large indoor and outdoor events, and to late night venues. Individuals are also asked to continue testing with lateral flow tests before meeting up with people from other households, to help reduce the risk of transmission.

Face coverings must still be worn in public indoor settings and on public transport.

NHS WESTERN ISLES

Mental health and wellbeing is as important to us all as our physical health in our everyday functioning.

NHS Western Isles are currently training an Enhanced Psychological Practitioner, who is able to offer 6 - 8 sessions to help those struggling with anxiety, mild depression, OCD or panic.

The approach helps people to use techniques to change their thoughts, feelings and behaviours to reduce symptoms and achieve personal goals. The service is based within the Community Navigator Team.

If you are over 18 years old and interested in finding out more, or to access this service, call **01851 708022** or email **wi.ccbtadminwisles@nhs.scot**.

LESS SURVIVABLE CANCERS AWARENESS

With new treatments, and better screening, many cancers have seen remarkable progress in survivability in recent years. However, others are just as deadly as they were 40 years ago. Together, six of these less survivable cancers make up a quarter of cancer cases, and sadly are responsible for half of all deaths from common cancers.

Today, on average, those diagnosed with lung, pancreatic, liver, brain, oesophageal and stomach cancers have only a 16% chance of surviving for 5 years after diagnosis.

Part of the reason is that less survivable cancers are difficult to diagnose, as they often have vague or non-specific symptoms, and so many are diagnosed at a more advanced stage.

Awareness of the symptoms of the deadliest cancers is thought to be as low as 4% in the UK, and so in January 2022, the first Less Survivable Cancers Awareness Day was launched.

The aim is to raise awareness of the most common symptoms, and to encourage people to access medical advice earlier.

Typical symptoms will vary, and not all people who experience them will be diagnosed with cancer, but red flags for less survivable cancers could include:

Indigestion	Abdominal Pain	Unexplained weight loss
A loss of appetite	Difficulty swallowing	A persistent cough
Unexplained tiredness	Headaches	Nausea

The Less Survivable Cancers Taskforce want everyone to be aware of these symptoms, and to see their GP swiftly if anything is unusual.

Over the next few months we will be publishing information relating to each of these cancers in the hope of raising awareness. In the meantime, if you'd like to find out more take a look at their website:

<https://less survivable cancers.org.uk/>

CO-OP MACAULAY ROAD

The Co-op have changed their delivery days for Uig and Bernera. Deliveries will now be between 2pm and 4pm every Tuesday and Thursday.

SCALADALE CENTRE

Love being on the trails on your mountain bike? Enjoy working with lots of different people? Imagine being able to do both as a MIAS qualified L1 or L2 mountain bike leader! Scaladale Centre is running a two day training and assessment course from the 1st March, and are looking for two more candidates. To find out more contact Kirsty or Francois on **01859 502502**, or email info@scaladale.co.uk

THE RAIDER TRAILER

The Raider Trailer, a mobile catering trailer based in Uig, is looking for a part-time staff member. Ready to start the season in mid April, the role will include taking customer orders, and food prep / serving. Cooking experience would be an advantage but not essential as training can be given. £10 per hour, up to 16 hours per week. For more information phone **07812 443642** or email theraidertrailer@gmail.com.

CLEANER

Looking for a cleaner to provide light domestic house work in Uig for 2 lovely, older people in their own homes. 3 hours per week, or 4 hours a fortnight. For more information call, text, or whatsapp **07958 549784**

UIG SANDS

Uig Sands Restaurant are looking to add to both their front of house and kitchen teams. Experience is preferred but not essential as training will be given. In return they offer a very fair rate of hourly pay, superb and equally shared tips, free staff meals, and accommodation if needed. The ideal candidates should be hard working, team players, show initiative, have a keen eye for attention to detail, with an outgoing personality and enjoy customer service.

Applications can be made by sending a copy of your C.V to **kenny@uigsands.co.uk**

CRUST

Do you love pizza, have an eye for detail and a great personality? If so, Crust are recruiting for full time and part time roles to join their small but awesome team, for their pizza business based in Achmore. Experience of working as a barista, chef, or other roles in hospitality is beneficial, but not essential as full training will be given.

They're an accredited Living Wage employer, which means all their roles pay at least £9.80 plus holidays and pension scheme, and of course you get free pizza too!

To find out more, or to apply, email **hello@crustlikethat.co.uk**

CHANGEOVERS

Looking for someone to carry out changeovers for a holiday let in Uig on Fridays. Good rates of pay for the right person. Contact Elly on **07952 332746** for more information.

THE CHANGING OF THE SEASONS

A walk around the castle grounds yesterday got me thinking about a report I have recently read. A new study has found that climate change is causing plants to flower almost a month earlier on average in the UK. Yesterday, both the broom and the gorse had the odd flower on, and the honeysuckle was well into leaf.



Of course, we all enjoy seeing the first signs of spring. A reminder that the harsh days of winter may soon be over. However, whilst most of us may welcome these untimely blooms, scientists are warning of the associated risks. They say that should the trend continue, there are knock-on effects for birds, insects and whole ecosystems. With Autumn also being delayed in many places, not all plants and animals are adapting at the same rate.

For those of us who grow our own fruit, we understand the damage caused by flowers appearing too early. Frost, wind, and even heavy, especially continuous rain, can all cause the flowers to die before the chance of pollination, or before the fruit has a chance to develop properly. With pollen, nectar, seeds and the fruits all providing important food sources for so many of our insects and animals, it is perhaps easy to understand the concern.

I will, of course, still relish the first glimpse of the blossom, and smile at the snowdrops bravely pushing through the soil at what can seem such a hard time of year.

I will still get excited when I spot the first celandine, but I may start marking it on the calendar, just in case!



Sam Millns
Kirkibost



GREAT BERNERA COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT TRUST

Welcome to the Trust's new page, where each month we'll keep you up to date with current projects, news and views.

THE GBCDT – WHO ARE WE, WHAT DO WE DO?

In 2013, The Great Bernera Community Development Trust was set up to promote the economic and social development of Great Bernera and the Tir Mor. Currently, the Trust comprises of Chair and Trustee members; Anne Ryan (Chair), Callum J Macaulay, Tom MacDonald, Rhiannon Teather, Norma MacLeod, Ella Macaulay and Tony Spinks.

THE TRUST'S WORK

A glance at GBCDT projects (past, present and future).

Community Land Buy Out (2013 – present)

Mapping of Bernera Estate (completed 2017)

Pontoon Facility at Kirkibost pier and Amenities (2016-present)

New Social Housing Site (researching for future development)

Purchase of Salmon Hatchery Building, Kirkibost Pier area (researching for future development)



COMING UP.....

Each month we'll be looking more in depth at one of the above projects and how it is progressing.

It only seems fitting when writing about the work of the Trust to mention Joan Macaulay. For many years the Trust was blessed by Joan who worked steadfastly in our community as a keen supporter and appointed Community Development Officer. Her work and enthusiasm for the place and people of Bernera has helped the community towards its goals in so many ways. Greatly saddened by her passing, and in Joan's memory, we would like to acknowledge her work and say a huge thanks on behalf of all of the community.

OTHER NEWS

This month, the Trust appointed Joanna George with the role of 'Community Co-ordinator'. She will be spending the next few months working on a variety of projects for, and with, members of the community – that's you! This role has been made possible through funding received from the Community Recovery Fund.

Joanna will also be gathering information for visitors and newcomers to Bernera and as such is asking if anyone has any good photographs of the people and places, activities, or wildlife that they would like to share on a future GBCDT Trust website, or on this page, then please get in touch with her. The photographer will be credited.

Joanna's contact details are: jogeorge6688@outlook.com or call **07771534048** - she can call you back to save charges.

GEALAGAN - LÀIR



Beagan sheachdainean air ais bha mi a' coimhead air prògram mu ghealagan-làir air an telebhisean agus bha e glè inntinneach. Bha eòlaiche ag radha gu bheil timcheall air dà mhìle còig ceud seòrsa eadar-dhealaichte ann air feadh Bhreatainn agus tha cuid dhiubh gu math tearc. Tha daoine ann a bhios a' cruinneachadh gealagan-làir agus a tha deònach tòrr airgid a phàigheadh air lusan sònraichte.

Gu mì - fhortanach 's e deagh naidheachd a tha sin do mèirlich oir bidh iad ag èaladh do na gàrraidhean-lusan gan goid agus an uair sin gan reic ri luchd- cruinneachaidh. As t-earrach tha mòran ghàrraidhean air feadh na dùthcha fosgailte do luchd-tadhail far am faic iad bratan-ùrlair brèagha, geala cho fada 's a ruigeas an t-sùil. Nuair a bha mi nam nighean dh'fhàs gealagan-làir gu pailt anns a' choille faisg air an taigh agus anns a' ghàrradh againne cuideachd.

Gach bliadhna bha mi a' feitheamh ris a' chiad dìthean. Bha mi air bhioran oir bha e iongantach nuair a noch-dadh a' chiad cheann beag às an t-sneachda.

Gidheadh, cha robh ceud againn na dìtheanan a ghearradh neo an toirt a-steach dhan taigh.

Dh' innis ar màthraichean dhuinn gun toireadh sin droch fhortan. Thàinig am beachd seo bho àm nam Bhictorianach a bha glè shaobh-chràbhach.

Leugh mi gun d'fhuair na dìtheanan seo an ainm bho fhailbheachanan agus chan ann bho bleideagan - sneachda. Anns a 15mh, 16mh is an 17mh linn, bhiodh boireannaich gu tric a' cleachdadh fhailbheachanan fada, geala air cruth bonneige ris an canaist "boinneagan-cluaise".

'S e a' ghealag-làir a' chiad bhlàth a tha a' fàs anns a' bhliadhna ùr, mar sin 's e samhla dòchais agus ath - nuadhachaidh a th' innte.

Linne NicLeòid
Dun Innes



BERNERA BAKES... ALL-WEATHER BARBECUE CHICKEN

INGREDIENTS:

- 4** large chicken legs, with skin on
- 75ml** (3fl oz) tomato ketchup
- 15g** (½oz) soft brown sugar
- 3** tablespoons clear honey
- juice of ½ lemon
- 2** cloves of garlic, peeled and crushed



METHOD:

- 1.** Preheat the oven to 200°C/400°F/Gas 6. Slash through the skin of each chicken leg, then arrange in a large roasting tin. Roast for 30 minutes. Pour the excess fat out of the tin.
- 2.** Whisk together the ketchup, sugar, honey, lemon juice and garlic. Brush the mixture over the chicken and cook for a further 25 minutes, basting a couple of times with the cooking juices, until beginning to caramelise.
- 3.** Check that the chicken is cooked through, the juices should run clear when the thickest part of the leg is pierced with a skewer.
- 4.** Serve immediately with potato salad and mixed leaves.

Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



DIRECTION

Surrounded by the sea and not too far away hills, many of our neighbours, friends and visitors need to know where they are to navigate forward. Whether that be at sea in a boat; on the hills gathering sheep; or simply to program a model drone to fly overhead recreationally.

The story is told of a WW1 sailor, Owen Edwards by name, who saved many lives when he used a compass located on the ship's lifeboats, following a direct hit by a German U-Boat. Without that simple instrument, all would have perished.

Today GPS is used, but failing that the compass is still available to help. It helps us to find North, irrespective of where we are on land or sea, allowing the user to work out where they truly are in relation to fixed points on a map. Such a compass provides us with a comfort and a confidence that by following its direction we will always be walking on a correct path. In a similar way, the Word of God found in the Bible can act as a compass, helping us to know the true direction God wishes us to follow in life. A word compass, that guides us not to follow the direction of an instrument in life, but a Person – Jesus.

The Jesus who directs us to follow Him, promising, *"I am the way, the truth, and the life."* Jn 14:6

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



DEAD PUFFINS



Sadly, a couple of weeks ago a dead puffin was found washed up on Bosta beach. This follows on from more than 100 that have been found on the shores of Northeast Scotland, Orkney and Shetland so far this winter. Thus becoming one of the most significant reports of its kind in the UK for this time of year in the past 50 years.

The cases are being recorded by the UK Centre for Ecology and Hydrology (UKCEH), which carries out long-term monitoring studies to detect the effects of environmental change on UK seabird populations. Many of the birds that have been found appear to be emaciated, which

suggests there could be a problem within the birds' food supply, but it is too early to say for sure if this is the case.

Whilst further research is carried out the general public are being asked to be vigilant. Anyone who spots a dead puffin is asked to safely take a photograph of it, without touching it. The photo should show the whole bird, with a clear view of its beak and wings. Please then send it to UKCEH via email enquiries@ceh.ac.uk. If you see birds that are alive but sick please contact the SSPCA on **03000 999 999**

TV QUIZ ANSWERS

- | | | |
|------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| 1. Dad's Army | 12. Pointless | 23. Tracy Island |
| 2. The Bill | 13. Pot Black | 24. Green Arrow |
| 3. Van Der Valk | 14. On the Buses | 25. Dragon's Den |
| 4. Magpie | 15. Jeremy Thorpe | 26. Farm |
| 5. James Herriot | 16. The Repair Shop | 27. Wrestling |
| 6. Breakfast | 17. Sportscene | 28. Craiglang |
| 7. Border | 18. Top of the Pops | 29. Illya Kuryakin |
| 8. Postman Pat | 19. Aberdeen | 30. The Vital Spark |
| 9. Adam West | 20. AC12 | |
| 10. 22nd | 21. Johnny Morris | |
| 11. Tarzan | 22. Red Dwarf | |

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost

